



EU Business & Economics

Spring 2026

2X

Manuel Prevot





We are HERE !!!

« *EBE* » *Step by Step* *PROGRAM...*

Ch 1
CONTEXT
(History & Law)

Ch 2
FUNCTIONING
(ECO & EURO)

Ch 3
POLICY
(EU Policies)

Ch 4
BUSINESSES
(Corporate & Consumers)





« *EBE* » *Step by Step*

between theory and reality...

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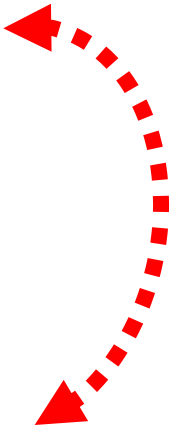
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Important milestones on the way to the EU

- ▶ 1951 : CECA:
- ▶ 1957: Treaty of Rome joining the 6 CECA founders around the creation of an extended common market : EEC organised by supra national institutions
- ▶ 1985 : Schengen Treaty : abolition of internal borders
- ▶ 1986: Single Act treaty organising the single market
- ▶ 1992: Maastricht : From the CEE to the EU: Macro economic governance
- ▶ 1999: Introduction of the single currency : €
- ▶ 2007: Lisbon Treaty /New process for making decisions simplifies the functioning
- ▶ 2008: start of the financial crisis and Greece Bail Out in 2010
- ▶ 2016: Brexit

Schuman Declaration



ECSC flag

Treaty of Rome



EFTA

11 1948: Cold War
On June 24, Soviet authorities in Berlin cut off all land, water, and rail routes to West Berlin. Within two days Britain, France and the US respond with a fifteen-month long airlift that successfully supplies the isolated West Berliners.

13 1949: OEEC
To fulfil the Marshall Plan condition that European countries collaborate on the fair distribution of the aid supplied, the Europeans create the Organization for European Economic Cooperation (OEEC).

Marshall Plan countries

27 1959: EFTA
As a reaction to the creation of the EEC in 1958, Austria, Denmark, Norway, Portugal, Sweden, Switzerland, and the UK create the European Free Trade area (EFTA). Due to its size, a combined population of 90m vs. 170m of the EEC, EFTA lacks credibility from the start. Less than two years later, the UK applies for membership in the EEC.

18 1950: Schuman Declaration
French Foreign Minister Robert Schuman announces plans for a supranational European Coal and Steel Community (ECSC). The community pools French and German coal and steel production to make future conflict unthinkable.

17 Steps
In the early fifties, Monnet defines the key formula to Europe's progress: small, practical steps toward a united Europe...

22 1954: Common Defense overruled
The French National Assembly rejects the European Defense Community Treaty due to the prospect of putting French troops under German command.

26 1959: Turkey I
The EEC accepts Turkey's application for associate membership. Within a decade Turkish workers will have become a key factor in keeping Europe's factories going.

"Europe will not be made all at once or according to a single plan. The pooling of coal and steel production should immediately provide for the setting up of common foundations for economic developments as a first step in the federation of Europe." Schuman, 1950

"The program should be a joint one, agreed to by a number, if not all, European nations." George Marshall, 1947

"...If Europe were...united in the sharing of its common inheritance, there would be no limit to the happiness, to the prosperity and glory which its three or four hundred million people would enjoy. We must build a kind of United States of Europe." Churchill, 1946

"We can never sufficiently emphasize that the six Community countries are the forerunners of a broader, united Europe, whose bounds are set only by those who have not yet joined. Our Community is not a coal and steel producers association: it is the beginning of Europe." Jean Monnet

"It's almost peculiar when you consider that in previous decades iron and steel caused division among the nations of Europe, and now Europe's iron, steel, and coal will lead towards community." Konrad Adenauer, 1951

21 1953: ECSC into action
The first coal transfer from Germany to France

16 1951: Coal and Steel
The creation of a single body to rule over European coal and steel, once the two resources that fueled wars, is intended to make future wars virtually impossible. Material resources prove to be more concrete, less political subjects of discussion than war and peace.

"The setting up of a European Army cannot result from a mere grouping together of national military units." René Pleven, former French President, and President of the ESCG Council, 1964

28 1961: Berlin Wall I
A desperate measure by the Communist regime to counteract the increasing inequality between East (poor) and West (rich) will divide the city of Berlin for more than 28 years.

14 Monnet III
After the failure of the League of Nations, Monnet is convinced that, to create European Unity, the agenda should be determined by practical rather than political subjects. He also insists on the importance of a higher authority in order to avoid the paralysis that characterized the League of Nations.

15 Engrenage
Monnet introduces the principle of engrenage, meshing, which involves civil servants from individual member states in the work of European institutions. According to this model, collaboration on one topic will inevitably lead to collaboration on another, making the integration of Europe irreversible.

20 1952-1955 Monnet IV
Jean Monnet serves as the first chairman of the High Authority of the ECSC.

10 1947: Marshall Plan
In a speech at Harvard, US Secretary of State George C. Marshall announces a multi-billion-dollar plan for European economic recovery. As a condition for receiving Marshall Plan aid, European governments are required to collaborate on a framework to implement the program.

25 1955: A German Commission President
Walter Hallstein, a former West German Foreign Minister, is elected the first President of the European Commission of the EEC. Hallstein remains President until 1967 and presides over a period of unprecedented economic success in Europe.

12 1949: NATO
Ten European states - the UK, France, Belgium, Holland, Luxembourg, Italy, Portugal, Norway, Denmark, and Iceland - sign a pact of mutual defense with the United States and Canada.

19 1949/1951: Treaty of Paris
"The Six" - Belgium, Netherlands, Luxembourg, West Germany, France, and Italy - establish the European Coal and Steel Community (ECSC), transferring broad control over their industries to a supranational authority. The ECSC is the embryo that eventually becomes the EU.

23 1955: Messina Conference
Foreign Ministers of "The Six" meet in a small Sicilian town for an intergovernmental conference to prepare what will become the Treaty of Rome.

24 1955: The Treaty of Rome
The principle of engrenage at work: two additional communities are formed: the European Atomic Energy Community (EAEC) and European Economic Community (EEC). It also introduces the idea of a Common Agricultural Policy (CAP) to eliminate hunger from the European continent. Only defense remains too controversial for a common European approach.

European Business & Economics

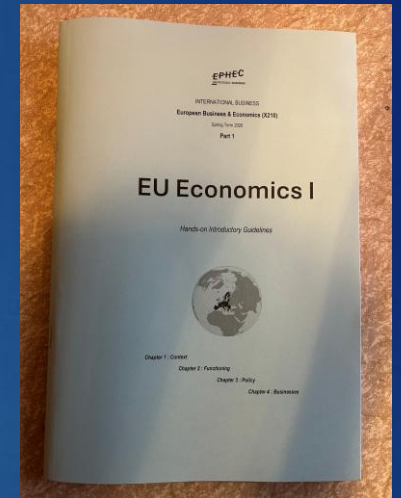
The European idea evolving in the History



European Business & Economics

Activity

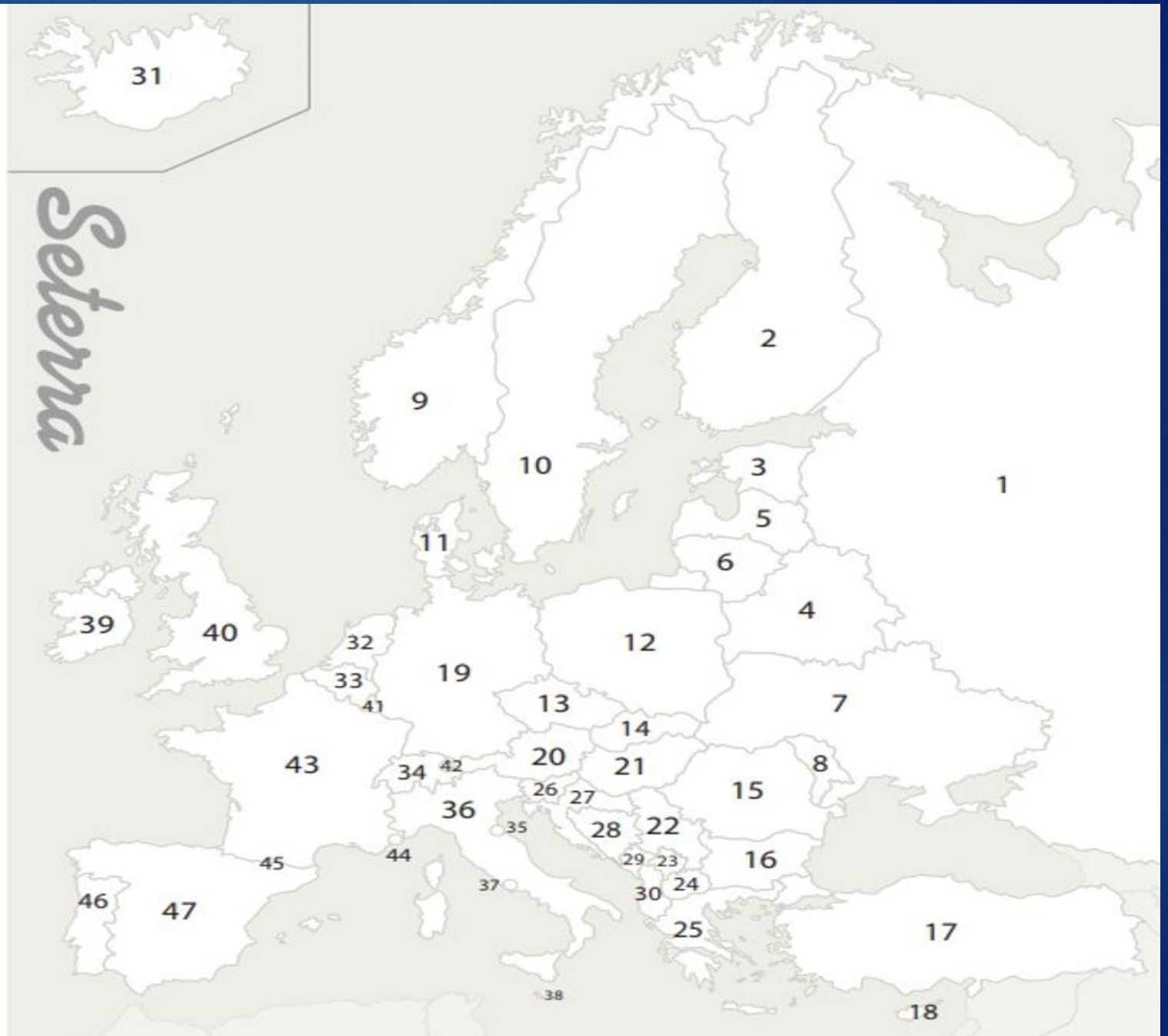
- EU different levels of integration highlighted on maps
- Blank Map of Europe : page 7 : Fill in the names



EUROPE | COUNTRIES

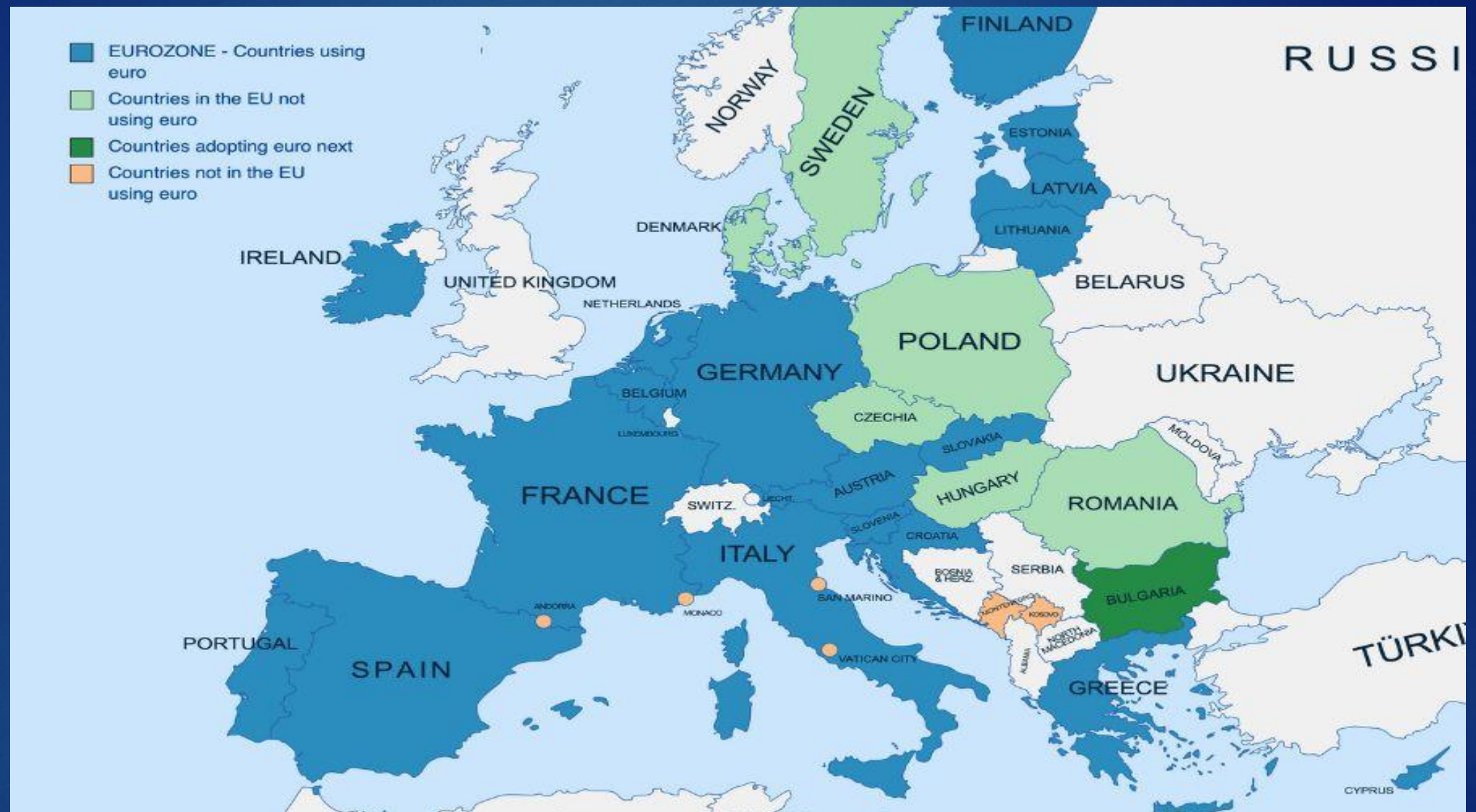
- | | |
|--------------|---------------------------|
| 1 Russia | 25 Greece |
| 2 Finland | 26 Slovenia |
| 3 Estonia | 27 Croatia |
| 4 Belarus | 28 Bosnia and Herzegovina |
| 5 Latvia | 29 Montenegro |
| 6 Lithuania | 30 Albania |
| 7 Ukraine | 31 Iceland |
| 8 Moldova | 32 Netherlands |
| 9 Norway | 33 Belgium |
| 10 Sweden | 34 Switzerland |
| 11 Denmark | 35 San Marino |
| 12 Poland | 36 Italy |
| 13 Czechia | 37 Vatican City |
| 14 Slovakia | 38 Malta |
| 15 Romania | 39 Ireland |
| 16 Bulgaria | 40 United Kingdom |
| 17 Turkey | 41 Luxembourg |
| 18 Cyprus | 42 Liechtenstein |
| 19 Germany | 43 France |
| 20 Austria | 44 Monaco |
| 21 Hungary | 45 Andorra |
| 22 Serbia | 46 Portugal |
| 23 Kosovo | 47 Spain |
| 24 Macedonia | |

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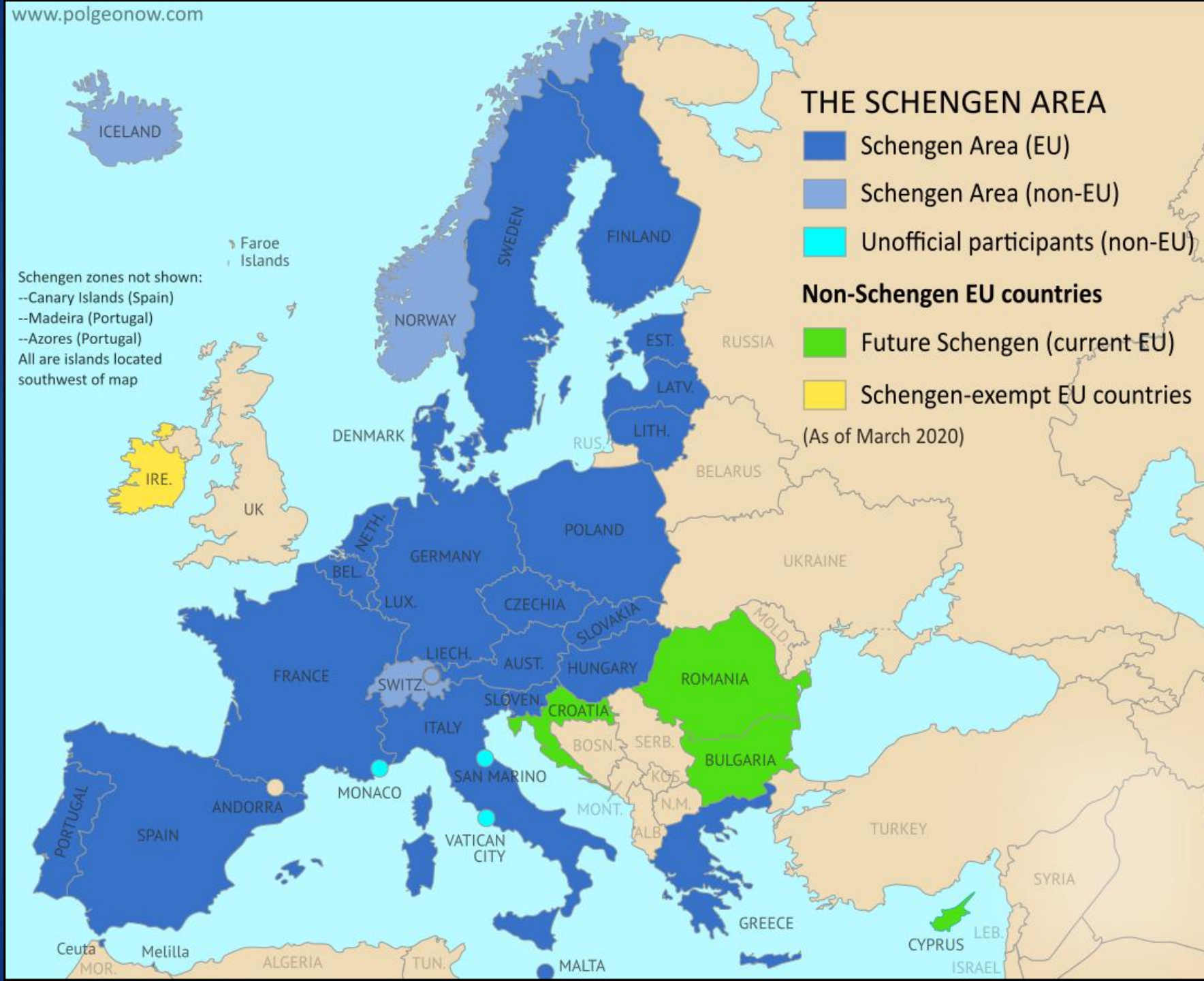




EU Members

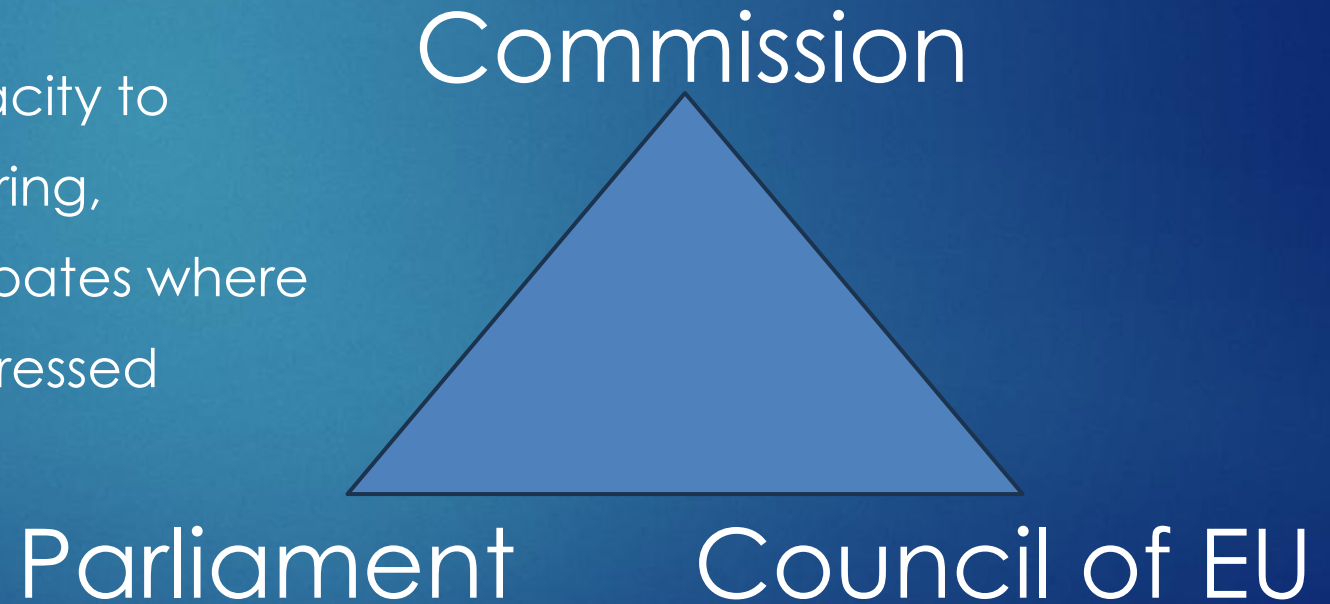


COUNTRIES USING the currency €



EU Institutions (Page 21)

- ▶ Triangle formed by 3 main permanent institutions : complex structure which is the result of finding the good balance between unity and diversity , sovereignty and shared power
- ▶ Balance between the capacity to take initiatives and the monitoring, the need to make political debates where sensibility of each can be addressed



European Commission

- ▶ Driving force
- ▶ Executive body (like a government)
- ▶ Initiate law
- ▶ Implement and manage budget
- ▶ Negotiate on behalf of EU members on the world stage (Trade)
- ▶ 27 commissioners , One per country but act for the community

European Parliament

- ▶ Legislative Body (share legislative power with the Council of EU)
- ▶ Members directly elected (democratic voice)
- ▶ Supervises the Commission and approves the Budget
- ▶ MP are teamed up by political color and not by nation

Council of the European Union (Council of Ministers)

- ▶ Represents the governments of the member states.
- ▶ Works with Parliament to adopt laws and approve the budget.
- ▶ Coordinates policies (e.g., economic, foreign affairs).
- ▶ Ministers meet in different configurations depending on the topic.

A fourth institution

The European Council

- ▶ Composed of heads of state or government of all EU countries.
- ▶ Sets the EU's overall political direction and long-term priorities.
- ▶ Does **not** pass laws but guides major decisions.
- ▶ Often described as providing the “strategic impulse” for the Union
- ▶ **Meeting : once per quarter**

Cooperation between EU institutions

Legislation

- ▶ **Commission** proposes laws.
- ▶ **Parliament** and **Council of the EU** jointly amend, negotiate, and adopt them under the *ordinary legislative procedure*.
- ▶ **European Council** sets the political priorities that guide what the Commission proposes.

Cooperation between EU institutions

Budget

- ▶ **Commission** drafts the budget.
- ▶ **Parliament** and **Council of the EU** negotiate and adopt it.
- ▶ **Commission** implements it.

Cooperation between EU institutions

Policy Coordination

- ▶ **European Council** defines strategic goals (e.g., climate, migration).
- ▶ **Commission** turns these into concrete proposals.
- ▶ **Council of the EU** coordinates national policies.
- ▶ **Parliament** ensures democratic oversight.

Cooperation between EU institutions

External Representation

- ▶ **Commission** negotiates trade agreements.
- ▶ **European Council** defines foreign policy direction.
- ▶ **Council of the EU** (Foreign Affairs configuration) implements it.
- ▶ **Parliament** must approve many international agreements.

Other important EU institution: ECB

European central Bank is responsible for managing the euro and ensuring price stability

Core Functions

- ▶ **Maintains price stability**
Its primary mission is to keep inflation low and stable, which supports sustainable economic growth.
- ▶ **Conducts monetary policy**
It sets key interest rates and uses tools like asset purchases to influence financial conditions in the eurozone.
- ▶ **Supervises major banks**
Through the Single Supervisory Mechanism, it oversees significant euro-area banks to ensure the safety and soundness of the financial system.
- ▶ **Manages the euro**
It safeguards the currency's stability and credibility, both within the EU and internationally.
- ▶ **Ensures smooth payment systems**
It oversees and operates systems that allow money to move securely across Europe.

Other important EU institution: Court of justice
CJEU is the EU's judicial authority to ensure that EU law is interpreted and applied consistently across all member states.

Core Functions

- Interprets EU law

National courts can ask the CJEU to clarify how EU rules should be understood.

- Ensures compliance

It can rule on whether member states or EU institutions have violated EU law.

- Settles disputes

It resolves legal conflicts between EU institutions, member states, businesses, and individuals involving EU legislation.

- Protects rights under EU law

Individuals and companies can challenge EU acts that directly affect them.

Functioning of EU Institutions workshop / Page 20

- ▶ Watch the video :

[How does the EU work? | CNBC Explains](#)

- ▶ Put your comments on page 20

You can be invited to share them in teams

European Competences

- ▶ Some are Exclusively managed by the EU: International trade
- ▶ Some are shared between EU and state members: Environment
- ▶ For some EU is just a support function: Health (Covid)

Activity : watch the video in teams

[Competences of the European Union](#)

Some will be called for sharing what they have retained

European law is supra national (above domestic law)

- ▶ Guideline (directives): set targets to state members which have to adapt their national laws like they want
- ▶ Rules (règlement) : take effect immediately for all EU citizens

Workshop Mercosur : Try to identify the EU institutions involved

- ▶ European Parliament freezes Mercosur deal, referring it to EU Court of Justice
- ▶ Article from the NY Times
<https://www.nytimes.com/2026/01/21/us/politics/mercosur-trade-deal-eu.html?smid=nytcore-ios-share>

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Corporations and &
Consumers are
impacted by EU
decisions !



It is YOUR LIFE !!!!!



European Business & Economics

Europe & Jobs !



It is YOUR LIFE !!!!!

In the STIB Metro Jan 2026 !!!!

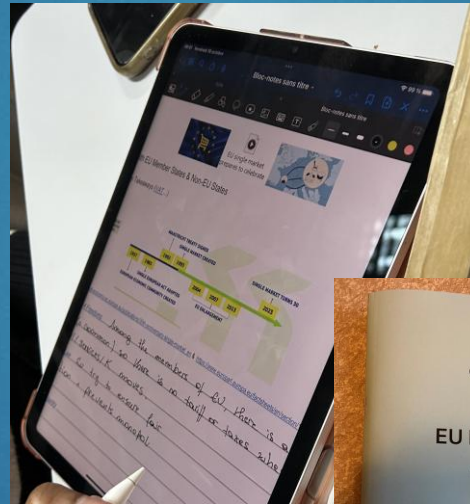
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Affects all aspects of
our daily life

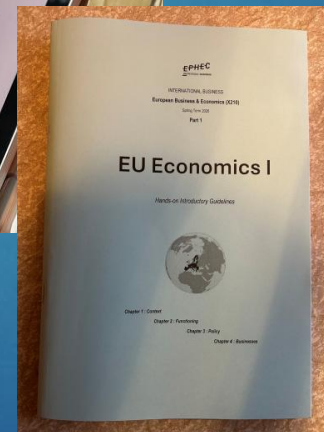


European Business & Economics

So...« EBE »...



**Will help you
understand better our
society !**



Assignment for the course 3
watch the video and put your
comments on page 17 after
discussion in teams

► [Europe From WWII To Today's European Union](#)

Some teams will be invited to the floor